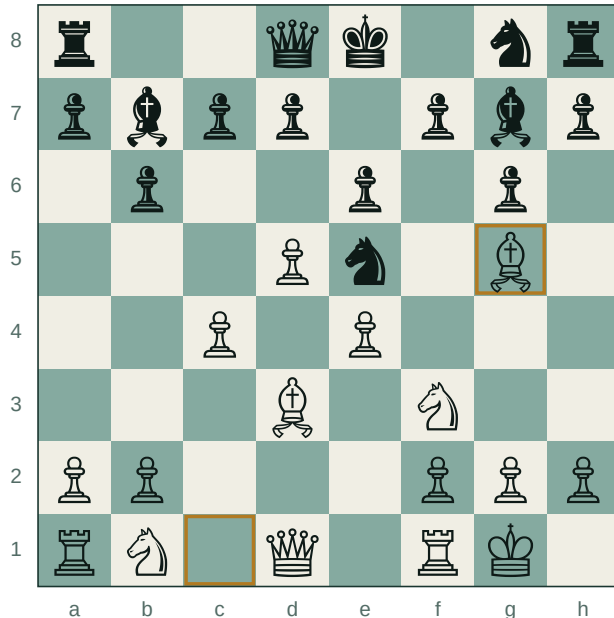


Kingside attacks: Black, move 8

Kingside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 8.Bg5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

8...Nxf3+ 9. Qxf3 Qxg5

8...Nxf3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From f3 it attacks king on g1 and bishop on g5. Recorded reply: **9.Qxf3**.

9...Qxg5 The queen captures the bishop on g5.

At the end, nominal material is White 33 / Black 36 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.